

VENTURE FOUNDRY OS

Phase 1.1 — Product Requirements Document

BoardMemory

Enterprise Decision Memory — Beachhead Product

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Sole strategic sources of truth:

Strategic Foundation Document v1.0

Founder Narrative and Venture Journey

Decision Freeze in effect. This PRD executes approved strategy; it does not reinterpret it.

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1. Executive Summary

BoardMemory is the first product built under Venture Foundry OS's Enterprise Decision Memory category. It is the beachhead application, not a standalone governance tool: its purpose is to prove, in one disciplined workflow, that organizational reasoning can be captured at the moment a decision is made and preserved as durable, queryable institutional memory.

Every enterprise system in the target market already stores documents — minutes, resolutions, PDFs. None of them store why a decision was made: the alternatives weighed, the assumptions relied on, the legal and financial advice received, the risks knowingly accepted. When the people who made a decision leave, that reasoning leaves with them. BoardMemory closes this gap for board governance, the highest-impact and most universal decision surface in any regulation-intensive organization.

This document is the Phase 1.1 deliverable of Venture Foundry OS. It translates the frozen Strategic Foundation Document v1.0 into an implementation-ready specification for a single V1 workflow: create a board meeting, capture the discussion and the reasoning behind each decision, run the vote and approval, generate the resulting minutes, resolution and action register, and commit all of it as a permanent, linked Decision Graph. Nothing in this PRD extends, redesigns, or reinterprets that scope.

Downstream engineering teams should treat Sections 13 (Functional Requirements), 16 (Core Domain Objects) and 21 (Acceptance Criteria) as the primary build specification, and Section 22 as an explicit boundary — useful for architectural awareness, not authorized for construction.

2. Product Vision

Over time, BoardMemory becomes the organization's System of Organizational Reasoning — a trusted memory layer that grounds governance, compliance, and future enterprise AI in the institution's own history, logic, and risk appetite.

BoardMemory begins with board governance because governance is where an organization's highest-impact decisions originate. The same reasoning infrastructure is intended, over time, to expand into compliance, licensing, contracts, trade and tax — but that expansion is out of scope for this PRD and is documented only for reference in Section 22.

Geographically, the vision targets organizations across Kenya, East Africa, and eventually the African continent, where institutional knowledge is frequently lost through staff turnover, fragmented documentation, and undocumented reasoning.

The vision is intentionally graph-centric, not AI-centric: the Decision Graph is the durable asset; AI is the retrieval and reasoning interface on top of it, not the product itself.

3. Company Thesis

We build the institutional memory layer for regulation-intensive organizations.

This is a company-level thesis, not a product-level one. BoardMemory is the first application of it, in the same way payments were Stripe's first application of financial infrastructure. Nothing in this PRD should be read as defining the company — only as executing its first product against this frozen thesis.

4. Category Thesis

Enterprise Decision Memory preserves organizational reasoning, assumptions, approvals and institutional knowledge.

Working definition, carried forward verbatim from the Strategic Foundation Document:

Enterprise Decision Memory is software that preserves organizational reasoning, assumptions, approvals, and institutional knowledge so that decisions become reusable rather than repeatedly recreated.

BoardMemory is explicitly not positioned as RegTech, LegalTech, Compliance AI, a board portal, or a document management system. Every functional requirement in Section 13 exists to serve this category definition; requirements that do not strengthen Enterprise Decision Memory are out of scope by construction.

5. Problem Statement

Core Problem

Organizations repeatedly recreate knowledge because enterprise systems preserve documents but fail to preserve reasoning.

Every symptom below is a consequence of this single root cause, as identified in the Strategic Foundation research:

- Lost board decisions — the outcome is on file; the reasoning is not.
- Lost procurement rationale.
- Lost legal interpretation.
- Lost trade assumptions.
- Lost ownership history.
- Lost approvals — what was approved is recorded; why it was approved is not.

Evidence from the Target Market

The Strategic Foundation records these as the actual language used by the buying personas, and they double as the qualitative baseline this PRD is designed against:

- Corporate secretary: “We spend three days reconstructing board history.”
- Law firm: “We repeat the same legal analysis.”
- Family office: “No one remembers why this trust was structured this way.”

- Auditor: “Show us why this decision was approved.”
- CEO: “The people who made this decision left.”

Customers are not buying AI or automation. They are already suffering from this problem today; BoardMemory is sold against the pain, not the technology.

6. Product Philosophy

Documents are evidence. Decisions are knowledge. AI is the interface; the memory graph is the product.

This is the single most load-bearing sentence in the Strategic Foundation. It resolves any future ambiguity about what BoardMemory is for: uploading and storing files is a supporting function (Evidence), not the product. The product is the structured, linked record of reasoning — the Decision Graph.

Product Principles (frozen)

- Capture reasoning at decision time.
- Represent knowledge as a graph.
- Preserve traceability.
- Expand through adjacent workflows.
- Every feature must strengthen Enterprise Decision Memory.

Any proposed feature that cannot be justified against one of these five principles falls outside V1 by definition, regardless of how useful it may otherwise seem.

7. Product Goals

Each goal below is a direct operationalization of the Company Thesis, Category Thesis and North Star (“reusable, searchable decision rationale”). No goal introduces new scope beyond the frozen strategy.

- G1 — Capture the full reasoning behind every board decision at the time it is made: alternatives considered, assumptions relied on, evidence referenced, and risk accepted.
- G2 — Preserve traceability between decisions, the people who made them, the evidence behind them, and the regulations or risks they relate to.
- G3 — Make institutional memory searchable and reusable, so that “why was this approved” has a stored answer rather than requiring reconstruction.
- G4 — Stand up the foundational Decision Graph architecture (Workflow Engine → Decision Capture → Memory Graph → AI Retrieval) that later expansion workflows (Section 22) will plug into without re-architecture.
- G5 — Deliver a workflow narrow and disciplined enough that a single board, inside a 50–500 employee organization, can adopt it with minimal onboarding friction.

8. Success Metrics

The Strategic Foundation defines a North Star — “reusable, searchable decision rationale” — but does not specify numeric targets. The categories below operationalize that North Star and the stated user pain points into measurable proxies. They do not introduce new business objectives.

Metric Category	What It Measures	Baseline / Source
Decision capture completeness	% of approved board decisions that have recorded rationale, alternatives and assumptions attached, not just an outcome.	Directly measures Core Problem resolution.
Time-to-context	Time required for a user to answer “why was this decided” for a past decision.	Qualitative baseline: “three days” per corporate secretary quote.
Decision Graph reuse	Number of times a past Decision, Assumption or Evidence record is retrieved or linked from a new Decision.	Direct proxy for North Star: reusable rationale.
Beachhead adoption	Number of boards / organizations with at least one complete Meeting → Decision Graph cycle.	Proxy for beachhead traction per ICP (Section 9).

Potential Strategic Change (Founder Approval Required): The Strategic Foundation Document does not specify numeric thresholds (e.g., target %, target adoption count, target time reduction) for any of the above categories. Engineering should build instrumentation to capture these metrics; setting the actual target values is a founder decision, not an architectural one.

9. Target Customer

Mid-sized regulation-intensive organizations (corporate secretaries, law firms, holding companies, NGOs, regulated SMEs).

Ideal Customer Profile (ICP)

50–500 employee organizations that have all of the following:

- Corporate Secretaries
- External Law Firms
- Boards
- Compliance obligations
- Multiple directors
- Annual filings
- Growth ambitions

Target Segments

- Holding companies
- Investment firms
- Family businesses
- Professional service firms

- NGOs
- Large SACCOs
- Regional companies

Explicitly Out of Scope for Customer #1

Large enterprises and banks are deliberately excluded from the beachhead — this is where governance already has enterprise software, and the founder-advantage / speed-to-value case is weaker. This exclusion is frozen strategy, not an oversight.

Geography

Initial focus is Kenya and East Africa, with eventual expansion across the African continent, where the institutional memory loss problem is acute due to staff turnover and fragmented documentation.

10. User Personas

Personas below are drawn directly from the buyer language already validated in the Strategic Foundation. No new personas are introduced.

Persona	Role in Workflow	Primary Pain (verbatim)	What V1 Must Give Them
Corporate Secretary	Primary operator: creates meetings, uploads documents, records the workflow end-to-end.	"We spend three days reconstructing board history."	A single place to capture a meeting once, with minutes and resolutions generated from what was already entered.
External Legal Counsel / Law Firm	Contributor: provides legal opinions attached as Evidence to specific decisions.	"We repeat the same legal analysis."	The ability to attach an opinion to a specific decision so it is retrievable the next time a similar question arises.
Board Director / CEO	Decision-maker: participates in discussion, votes, approves.	"The people who made this decision left."	A record of reasoning that survives departures — not dependent on any one person's memory.
Auditor / Compliance Reviewer	Downstream reader: retrieves rationale after the fact.	"Show us why this decision was approved."	Rationale retrieval: alternatives, assumptions, evidence and approvals for any past decision, on demand.
Family Office Principal	Long-horizon reader: relies on historical structuring rationale years later.	"No one remembers why this trust was structured this way."	Durable linkage between a decision and the assumptions/risks that justified it at the time.

11. User Problems

Each user problem below traces directly to the Core Problem (Section 5) and is addressed by specific functional requirements in Section 13.

- Reconstructing board history from scattered files and memory costs days of avoidable work each time a question is asked.
- Legal and financial analysis is redone for decisions that resemble ones already made, because the earlier reasoning was never captured as a retrievable object.
- Structuring rationale (why an entity, trust, or approval was set up a certain way) is lost once the people involved move on.
- Auditors and regulators ask “why” and organizations can only produce the “what” — the resolution or minute, not the reasoning.
- Staff and director turnover silently erases institutional memory that was never written down as structured knowledge.

12. Beachhead Workflow

BoardMemory is the beachhead into Enterprise Decision Memory. The Core Workflow, frozen in the Strategic Foundation, is:

Meeting → Discussion → Decision → Rationale → Approval → Minutes → Decision Graph

This resolves into the following detailed V1 sequence, which is the exact and complete scope of this PRD:

- 1. Create Board Meeting
- 2. Upload agenda
- 3. Upload supporting documents
- 4. Record discussion
- 5. Capture reasoning
- 6. Record assumptions
- 7. Capture alternatives
- 8. Vote
- 9. Approve
- 10. Generate minutes
- 11. Generate resolution
- 12. Generate action register
- 13. Create Decision Graph
- 14. Store permanently

Nothing precedes step 1 and nothing follows step 14 within V1. This chain is the beachhead — not a governance platform, one exceptional workflow.

13. Functional Requirements

Every requirement below traces to a step in the Beachhead Workflow (Section 12) and to a named element of the Product Constitution. FR-16 through FR-18 implement the Memory Graph and AI Retrieval layers of the Technical Vision.

ID	Requirement	Description	Traces To
FR-01	Meeting Creation	User creates a Board Meeting record with date, type, Organization, and attending Persons.	Core Workflow: Meeting; Objects: Meeting, Person, Organization
FR-02	Agenda Upload	User uploads an agenda document and associates it with a Meeting.	Core Workflow: Meeting; Object: Evidence
FR-03	Supporting Document Upload	User uploads supporting documents (financials, legal opinions, reports) and links each to a specific agenda item or Decision.	Philosophy: “Documents are evidence”; Object: Evidence
FR-04	Discussion Recording	User records discussion notes tied to an agenda item, prior to a Decision being finalized.	Core Workflow: Discussion
FR-05	Decision Capture	User creates a Decision record linked to a Meeting and an agenda item.	Core Workflow: Decision; Object: Decision
FR-06	Rationale Capture	User records the rationale — the reasoning — behind a Decision, independent of its outcome.	Core Workflow: Rationale; Philosophy: “Decisions are knowledge”
FR-07	Assumption Capture	User records one or more Assumptions (financial, legal, risk) underlying a Decision.	Object: Assumption
FR-08	Alternatives Capture	User records alternatives considered before a Decision was reached.	Product Definition: “alternatives considered”
FR-09	Risk & Obligation Linking	User links a Decision to relevant Risk and Obligation records.	Objects: Risk, Obligation
FR-10	Voting	User records a vote on a Decision, including which Persons voted for, against, or abstained.	Core Workflow: Approval; V1 step: Vote
FR-11	Approval	User formally marks a Decision as Approved, capturing approving Persons and the approval date.	Core Workflow: Approval; V1 step: Approve
FR-12	Minutes Generation	System generates Meeting Minutes from the recorded Meeting, Discussion, Decisions, Votes and Approvals.	V1 step: Generate minutes; Output: Board Minutes
FR-13	Resolution Generation	System generates a Resolution document from an Approved Decision.	Object: Resolution; Output: Board Resolutions
FR-14	Action Register Generation	System generates an Action Item register from Decisions that require follow-up.	Object: Action Item
FR-15	Decision Graph Construction	System links Decision, Meeting, Resolution, Person, Organization, Regulation, Risk, Assumption, Obligation, Evidence, Action Item and Relationship records into one queryable graph.	Philosophy: “the memory graph is the product”; Technical Vision: Memory Graph

ID	Requirement	Description	Traces To
FR-16	Rationale Retrieval	User can search and retrieve the rationale behind any past Decision.	North Star: reusable, searchable decision rationale; Output: Rationale Retrieval
FR-17	Permanent Storage	All Decision Graph data is stored permanently and remains retrievable independent of the person who created it.	V1 step: Store permanently; “The people who made this decision left.”
FR-18	AI Retrieval Interface	An AI interface allows natural-language queries against the Decision Graph, to retrieve rationale — it does not replace the graph as the system of record.	Technical Vision: AI Retrieval; Philosophy: “AI is the interface”

14. Non-Functional Requirements

These requirements operationalize the Product Constitution into architectural constraints. They do not add product features.

ID	Category	Requirement	Rationale
NFR-01	Traceability	Every Decision Graph entry retains an immutable record of who captured it and when.	Directly enables answering “why was this approved” — the core sales moment (Section 5).
NFR-02	Versioning, not overwrite	Once a Decision is Approved, edits create a new version rather than overwriting the original.	Preserves traceability (Product Principle); protects institutional memory from silent revision.
NFR-03	Confidentiality & Access Control	Board materials are highly sensitive; access is scoped per Organization and per Meeting.	Regulation-intensive customer base (Section 9) requires confidentiality by default.
NFR-04	Data residency	Data residency and regulatory storage requirements for Kenya / East Africa must be confirmed before production launch.	Initial geography per Product Vision (Section 2).
NFR-05	Reliability of record-keeping	The system behaves as a governance system of record: no silent data loss for Decisions, Approvals, or Evidence.	Institutional memory that can be lost defeats the Category Thesis.
NFR-06	Right-sized scale	Architecture is sized for single-board, 50–500 employee organizations — not large-enterprise concurrency or volume.	ICP (Section 9); avoids over-building for V1.
NFR-07	Graph-first data model	The underlying data model must represent Core Domain Objects (Section 16) and their Relationships natively — not as an afterthought on top of a document store.	Philosophy: “the memory graph is the product.”

Potential Strategic Change (Founder Approval Required): Specific SLAs, uptime targets, and confirmed data-residency jurisdictions are not defined in the Strategic Foundation Document. These require founder/engineering-leadership sign-off before they are treated as commitments.

15. User Stories

- As a Corporate Secretary, I want to create a board meeting record and upload the agenda and supporting documents, so that I don't have to reconstruct board history from scattered files later.
- As a Corporate Secretary, I want to have minutes and resolutions generated from what I already captured, so that I don't duplicate documentation work I've already done once.
- As a Board Director, I want to record the alternatives and assumptions considered before a vote, so that future readers understand why we chose this option, not just what we chose.
- As a External Legal Counsel, I want to attach a legal opinion as evidence to a specific decision, so that our analysis is not repeated for a similar future decision.
- As a Auditor, I want to retrieve the full rationale, evidence, and approval trail behind a past decision, so that I can verify it was properly governed without reconstructing it manually.
- As a CEO, I want to have institutional memory of decisions persist even after the people who made them leave, so that continuity survives staff and director turnover.
- As a Any authorized user, I want to query the Decision Graph in natural language, so that I can find relevant past rationale without knowing exactly where it was stored.

16. Core Domain Objects

These twelve objects, frozen in the Strategic Foundation, form the Decision Graph. No object is renamed, merged, split, or added beyond this list without a founder-approved change.

Object	Definition	Key Relationships
Decision	The central knowledge unit: an approved (or rejected) choice, together with its rationale.	Meeting, Rationale, Assumption, Risk, Evidence, Person, Resolution, Action Item
Meeting	A single Board Meeting instance, with date, type and attendees.	Organization, Person, Decision, Evidence (agenda/documents)
Resolution	The formal document generated from an Approved Decision.	Decision, Person (approvers), Meeting
Person	An individual participant — director, secretary, counsel, auditor — involved in the workflow.	Meeting, Decision (vote/approval), Organization
Organization	The customer entity whose governance is being recorded.	Meeting, Person, Regulation, Obligation
Regulation	A regulatory reference relevant to a Decision.	Decision, Obligation, Organization
Risk	A risk acknowledged or accepted as part of a Decision.	Decision, Assumption
Assumption	A financial, legal or operational assumption underlying a Decision.	Decision, Risk, Evidence
Obligation	A compliance or contractual obligation connected to a Decision.	Decision, Regulation, Organization

Object	Definition	Key Relationships
Evidence	A supporting document — agenda item, legal opinion, financial report — attached to a Decision or Meeting.	Meeting, Decision, Assumption
Action Item	A follow-up task generated from a Decision.	Decision, Person (owner)
Relationship	The explicit, typed link connecting any two Core Domain Objects inside the Decision Graph.	Any object ↔ any object

17. Product Scope (V1)

Board governance workflows only.

V1 scope is exactly the fourteen-step Beachhead Workflow in Section 12, implemented via FR-01 through FR-18 in Section 13, over the twelve Core Domain Objects in Section 16. Nothing outside this boundary — no other workflow, object, or output — is in scope for this release, regardless of how naturally it might seem to extend from board governance.

We are not building an enterprise platform. We are building one exceptional workflow.

18. Explicit Non-Goals

Not ERP, CLM, DMS, chatbot or generic note app.

In addition to the category-level non-goals above, the following are explicitly out of scope for V1 — not because they lack merit, but because they belong to the Future Expansion Boundary (Section 22) and pulling any of them forward requires founder approval under the Decision Freeze:

- Beneficial Ownership tracking
- Annual Returns management
- Licensing workflows
- Compliance Calendar as a standalone module
- Risk Register as a standalone module (Risk exists in V1 only as an object linked to a Decision)
- Policy management
- Contract lifecycle management
- Trade workflows
- Tax workflows

19. Product Constraints

- The Decision Graph, not any document store or AI chat surface, must remain the system of record — no feature may reduce it to a side effect of a conversational interface.

- No workflow, object, or output beyond the frozen V1 list (Sections 12, 13, 16) may be added without explicit founder approval, per the Decision Freeze.
- Core Domain Object names must be used exactly as defined in Section 16 across all downstream architecture and documentation, to keep terminology consistent for engineering.
- Initial deployment context is Kenya and East Africa; architecture should not assume jurisdictions, currencies, or governance norms outside this context without validation.
- Architecture should be right-sized for the stated ICP (50–500 employees, single-board usage) rather than designed for large-enterprise scale from day one.

20. Risks and Assumptions

These are execution-level risks surfaced in service of delivering the frozen strategy — they do not propose changing it. Items marked as assumptions should be validated, not treated as confirmed fact.

- Adoption risk: organizations may be reluctant to store highly confidential board reasoning in a new, unproven system — trust-building (security posture, references, pilot structure) is likely required before broad adoption.
- Category education risk: “Enterprise Decision Memory” is a new category; buyers are not searching for it by name, and go-to-market will need to sell against the pain (Section 5), not the category label.
- Data residency assumption: specific data residency and regulatory storage requirements for Kenya / East Africa are assumed to be findable and satisfiable, but are not yet confirmed (see NFR-04).
- AI reliability dependency: the Rationale Retrieval and AI Retrieval Interface (FR-16, FR-18) depend on AI accurately surfacing graph content; retrieval accuracy needs validation before being positioned as a core value driver.
- Competitive risk: existing board portal vendors could add rationale-capture features once the pattern is validated; the Decision Graph and cross-decision linkage (Section 16) is the intended differentiator, per the Strategic Foundation's stated moat.
- Execution model assumption: per the Founder Narrative, product development relies on AI-assisted (“vibe coding”) engineering rather than a traditional engineering team; delivery timelines and technical risk should be planned with this in mind.

21. Acceptance Criteria

Acceptance criteria are grouped by workflow stage. Each must hold before the corresponding Functional Requirements (Section 13) are considered complete.

Workflow Stage	Given	When	Then
Meeting & Documents (FR-01–FR-03)	A user has authority over an Organization	they create a Meeting and upload an agenda and supporting documents	the Meeting record exists with all documents stored as Evidence linked to it
Discussion & Decision (FR-04–FR-09)	A Meeting exists with an agenda item	the user records discussion, rationale,	a Decision record exists with all of the above linked to it,

Workflow Stage	Given	When	Then
		assumptions, alternatives, risks and obligations	independent of its eventual outcome
Vote & Approval (FR-10–FR-11)	A Decision has been discussed	the user records votes and marks the Decision Approved	the Decision stores voting Persons, outcome, approving Persons, and approval date
Output Generation (FR-12–FR-14)	One or more Decisions in a Meeting are Approved	the user requests outputs	Minutes, Resolution(s) and an Action Item register are generated from the captured data, with no re-entry of information
Decision Graph & Retrieval (FR-15–FR-18)	A Meeting's workflow is complete	any authorized user searches for a past Decision	the full rationale, alternatives, assumptions, evidence, and approval trail are retrievable, including via natural-language AI query

22. Future Expansion Boundary (Reference Only)

Potential Strategic Change (Founder Approval Required): Everything in this section is reference material for architectural awareness only. None of it is authorized for V1 construction. Pulling any item forward requires explicit founder approval under the Decision Freeze.

The frozen expansion path from the Strategic Foundation:

Governance → Beneficial Ownership → Compliance → Licensing → Contracts → Trade → Tax

Detailed V2 chain, for architectural awareness (e.g., to inform how loosely FR-15's Decision Graph should be coupled to board-specific concepts):

- Board
- Beneficial Ownership
- Annual Returns
- Licenses
- Compliance Calendar
- Risk Register
- Policies
- Contracts
- Trade
- Tax

Everything in this expansion plugs into Decision Memory — not into documents. This is the reason FR-15 (Decision Graph Construction) is specified as a generic graph over typed objects rather than a board-specific data structure, even though V1 populates it with board data only.

23. Glossary

Term	Definition
Enterprise Decision Memory	The category: software that preserves organizational reasoning, assumptions, approvals and institutional knowledge so decisions become reusable rather than repeatedly recreated.
Decision Graph	The linked network of Decision, Meeting, Resolution, Person, Organization, Regulation, Risk, Assumption, Obligation, Evidence, Action Item and Relationship records. The product itself, per the Product Philosophy.
Memory Graph	Used interchangeably with Decision Graph in the Technical Vision; the knowledge-graph layer that stores all Core Domain Objects and their Relationships.
Institutional Memory	The organizational reasoning, rationale and knowledge that is lost today when only documents (not decisions) are preserved.
Beachhead	The first, narrow market and workflow (BoardMemory, board governance) used to enter the Enterprise Decision Memory category before expanding to adjacent workflows.
Decision Freeze	The governance rule that the Strategic Foundation is frozen and may only be changed with explicit founder approval; this PRD operates under that freeze.
Product Constitution	The combined, frozen set of the Company Thesis, Category Thesis, Product Philosophy, Product Principles and Decision Freeze that this PRD is required to preserve without reinterpretation.
Rationale	The reasoning behind a Decision — distinct from the Decision's outcome, and the specific thing this product exists to capture.
Resolution	The formal governance document generated from an Approved Decision.
ICP	Ideal Customer Profile: 50–500 employee, regulation-intensive organizations, as defined in Section 9.
North Star	The single metric orientation for the product: reusable, searchable decision rationale.

Governance Note

This completes the Phase 1.1 deliverable. Per Venture Foundry OS operating instructions, this PRD now stops and awaits governance approval before proceeding to the Domain Model. Three items were flagged inline as Potential Strategic Change (Founder Approval Required): (1) numeric success-metric targets (Section 8), (2) SLA / uptime / confirmed data-residency jurisdiction (Section 14), and (3) any pull-forward of Future Expansion Boundary items (Section 22). Everything else in this document is execution of the existing Decision Freeze, not a proposed change to it.